

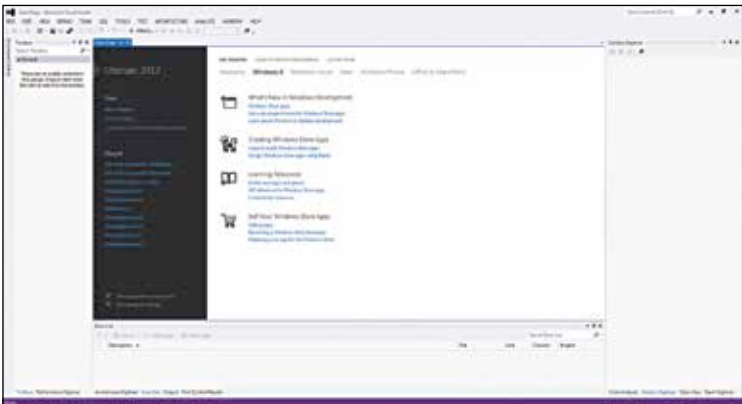
Tools and Learning Resources

The age of C has another significant advantage, there is a plethora of tutorials, books, videos, and the like available for C, and many of them are absolutely free.

There are also dozens of compilers and IDEs available for C, most free if not open source. However, of greatest important —for desktop OSs at least— are Microsoft's Visual C++ compiler, the GNU Compiler Collection (GCC), and the newer Clang. Clang aims to be a drop-in replacement for GCC, and features a similar interface. It is gaining popularity, and is now preferred by a number of BSDs and Apple —which is unsurprising since they are one of its primary developers.

If you are using Windows, you have a couple of options. Firstly Microsoft's C / C++ compiler ships with the Windows SDK and with their Visual Studio IDE. The SDK is free, and a free version of the Visual Studio IDE is available, and has recently expanded its feature-set quite a bit. If you intend to develop purely for Windows, wish to use Windows-specific features, or wish to write extensions for parts of Windows itself, you will need this. Even otherwise, the hallmarks of a well-developed piece of software is its ability to compile under multiple different compilers by different vendors.

On OSX the development tools are available with the SDK, and can be installed from the OSX DVD, or downloaded via the Mac App Store. This includes the XCode IDE. If you are using Linux, chances are development



Microsoft's new Visual Studio Community edition brings the free version of the IDE closer to the paid offering.